

KEMISOLA AANU ADELAKUN

Technical CRM Manager & Player Lifecycle Lead (iGaming)

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Technical CRM Lead with 8+ years in sports betting and iGaming, having built CRM functions from scratch at three different companies, most recently at Betjara, following GinjaBet and betBonanza.

I started my career in digital marketing, but the question that shaped my career was never how to acquire customers, it was how to keep them. I own player lifecycle strategy, retention, and promotional execution end-to-end, and works closely with Product, Engineering, Data, Risk, Payments, and Player Operations. I have led the design and execution of player lifecycle strategies, event-driven automations, advanced segmentation, bonus and gamification mechanics, VIP journeys, and CRM integrations that improve customer engagement and business performance.

I thrive in fast-paced, high-growth environments where CRM is a strategic growth function rather than just a marketing channel. With hands-on expertise with different CRM Tools, I have consistently delivered measurable results, including increasing monthly player retention from 0% to a sustained 25%, exceeding a 20% business target.

CORE CRM & RETENTION SKILLS

CRM Function Build-Out & Scaling

- Building CRM functions from scratch, done this at three companies now, covering operations, lifecycle strategy, and campaign frameworks.
- Translating business goals into technical CRM setups: segmentation, automation, and the logic behind them.
- CRM Tool Integration: hands-on with getting platforms like Optimove and FastTrack CRM working within the wider tech stack.

Bonuses, Promotions & Gamification

- Bonus & Promotion Design (Sportsbook, Live Casino, Virtuals & Casino).
- Free Bets, Deposit Bonuses, Free Spins.
- Wagering / Rollover & Expiry Logic.
- Gamification & Loyalty Mechanics.
- ROI & Margin Optimization.
- Bonus Abuse Prevention & Risk Controls.

Analytics, Testing & Optimization

- CRM KPIs: Retention, Reactivation, Conversion, Incremental Uplift
- A/B Testing (Messaging, Bonuses, Journeys)

Lifecycle Campaigns & Player Journeys

- End-to-End Lifecycle Strategy (Onboarding, Activation, Retention, Reactivation, Churn Prevention).
- Automated & Manual CRM Campaigns.
- Multi-Channel Execution (Email, SMS, Push, In-App, On-Site).
- Event-Triggered Journeys (Player Feature, Deposit, Bet, Loss, Win, Inactivity).
- Responsible Gaming & Compliance-Aligned Messaging.

Segmentation, Personalization & VIP

- Advanced Behavioural & Value-Based Segmentation.
- Player Risk & Abuse Segmentation.
- VIP Journey Design & Tiering Logic.
- High-Value Player Retention & Monetization.

CRM Tools

- Optimove
- FastTrack CRM
- Customer.io

- Cohort & Campaign Performance Analysis
- Data-Driven Optimization & Insight Delivery

- Xtremepush
- SendGrid
- Mailchimp

CROSS-FUNCTIONAL PARTNERSHIP & ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE

- Sits between CRM and the rest of the business, turning commercial goals into technical execution:
- Reports directly to CEO/Founder-level leadership, keeping CRM strategy aligned with company-wide commercial and growth goals.
- Works with Product & Engineering to define event-driven triggers, API/webhook integrations, and CRM-backend data flows.
- Works with Risk & Payments to design bonus eligibility, wagering logic, and abuse-prevention controls.
- Works with Player Operations & Customer Support to keep lifecycle messaging aligned with day-to-day player handling and compensation.
- Coordinates directly with IT and Integration teams on third-party platform integrations (bonus engine, payments providers).
- Usually, the sole technical owner of CRM in lean, startup-style setups, building the operating model rather than inheriting one.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Head, Technical CRM Manager – Avidlionz (BetJara) Jun 2026 – Present

Lagos, Nigeria

- Built the CRM function from the ground up at Betjara, the third time architecting a CRM operating model from inception, following GinjaBet and betBonanza.
- Own end-to-end CRM strategy, multi-channel campaign execution, and the full lifecycle of offers, promotions, and bonus activity using Optimove, architecting segmentation, automation, and event-driven trigger logic across the platform.
- Designed responsive HTML email templates and welcome bonus campaigns for Casino and Sports, running structured A/B tests and reporting results to inform channel and messaging decisions.
- Built cohort analysis frameworks and a direct organic player segment reporting automation to track campaign performance and support data-led decision-making.
- Built campaign logic and workaround segmentation to detect first-bet behaviour in the absence of native bet-count triggers, alongside weekly cashback campaign structures.
- Led a strategic "Nigerianising" initiative, converting percentage-based promotions into flat naira amounts to improve player comprehension and offer uptake.
- Proactively brief internal stakeholders across Product, Risk, Payments, and Player Operations on planned campaigns to maintain synergy and transparency.
- Coordinate with IT, Integration teams, external agency and vendor partners on bonus platform integration and campaign delivery, setting priorities to ensure high-quality execution in a lean structure with no direct reports.

Head, Technical CRM & CSM Manager – GinjaBet

Jan 2025 – Jun 2026

Lagos, Nigeria

- Built the CRM function from the ground up, establishing lifecycle strategy, segmentation, and campaign infrastructure across onboarding, activation, retention, reactivation, and churn prevention.
- Owned CRM QA, testing, monitoring, and deployment to ensure trigger accuracy and journey reliability, and ensured all activity aligned with responsible gaming, compliance, and brand standards.
- Designed and executed multi-channel CRM campaigns across email, SMS, push, in-app, and on-site messaging.
- Led the design and execution of sportsbook and casino bonuses, including free bets, deposit bonuses, and targeted retention offers.
- Defined bonus mechanics, wagering requirements, eligibility rules, expiry logic, and abuse-prevention controls in collaboration with Risk and Payments teams.
- Built advanced player segments based on behaviour, value, lifecycle stage, and product preference; implemented personalized journeys and offer cadence to maximize engagement and LTV.
- Grew monthly retention from 0% to a sustained 25%, exceeding the original 20% target through structured lifecycle and promotional optimization.

Head, Technical CRM – betBonanza **Dec 2019 – Dec 2024**
Lagos, Nigeria

- Built and scaled the CRM function from inception to support a sports betting platform with 500,000+ active players.
- Designed and maintained automated lifecycle journeys across acquisition, retention, churn prevention, and reactivation
- Led the design of bonus, loyalty, and gamification frameworks, balancing engagement, profitability, and risk
- Built VIP segmentation and differentiated CRM treatment for high-value players
- Partnered with Risk and Payments teams to identify and mitigate bonus abuse patterns, reducing margin leakage
- Designed and executed A/B tests across bonuses, messaging, and journey logic to maximize ROI
- Reduced CRM operational costs by 25% through automation and improved workflow efficiency
- Worked closely with Product and Engineering on CRM integrations, event tracking, and data flows

Digital Marketing Strategist – CCeramica **Jan 2018 – Nov 2019**
Lagos, Nigeria

- Developed and managed digital marketing campaigns
- Designed and executed social media strategies
- Managed and updated the company website
- Monitored analytics and prepared regular performance reports
- Performed ongoing SEO optimization

CRM & RETENTION PROJECTS

- Event-Driven CRM Architecture: implemented backend-triggered journeys for deposits, bets, wins/losses, inactivity, and churn signals using API/webhook integrations.
- CRM Payments Backend Integration, enabled automated bonus issuance, eligibility validation, and lifecycle messaging across sportsbook, payments, and CMS systems

EDUCATION

Obafemi Awolowo University – BA. Ed. English

Ile-Ife, Nigeria | Sep 2016

CLOUD PROJECTS & CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate (SAA) | 2024

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (CP) | 2024